
TODAY'S HEADLINE

AI's godfather just sounded the alarm.

Geoffrey Hinton called unregulated AI a fast car with no steering wheel. Same week, \$100M poured into AI for warfare, Google rewired Workspace, ElevenLabs turned music into a remix party, and a Japanese cat extension forced the internet to take a break. It has been a long 24 hours. Six stories. Eight minutes total.

MORNING DIGEST

What we cover today.

Six stories from the last 24 hours. Read in this order and you will be ahead of 90% of people in AI by lunch.

01

AI's godfather just sounded the alarm

Geoffrey Hinton calls unregulated AI a fast car with no steering wheel. Only 1% of AI work goes to safety.

02

\$100M just bought an AI brain for warfare

Scout AI's Fury raised the largest US defense Series A ever. Drone swarms, autonomous strikes, real DoD contracts.

03

Gemini just took over Google Workspace

Docs, Sheets, Slides, Drive. One prompt. Full draft. The blank page is officially dead.

04

ElevenLabs just turned music into a remix party

ElevenMusic relaunched. Stream, create, remix tracks from 4,000 artists. Fully licensed. Fans become producers.

05

AI agents just learned to run themselves

New arXiv batch on outcome-rewarded agents and neuro-symbolic reasoning. The babysitter era ends soon.

06

A giant orange cat is fixing the internet

Japanese indie dev shipped a Chrome extension that blocks your screen with a fat cat. Free. Viral.

01 . NEWS . THE SAFETY ALARM

AI's godfather just sounded the alarm.

QUICK TAKE

Geoffrey Hinton, Nobel laureate and the man who sparked the deep learning boom, told the 2026 Digital World Conference in Geneva that unregulated AI is "a very fast car with no steering wheel." His estimate of how much AI work goes into safety today: about 1%. He warned humanity may not be able to co-exist with super-intelligent systems if governance does not catch up.

WHAT YOU NEED TO KNOW

- **The line:** opponents of regulation say it slows progress. Hinton says they want a fast car with no steering wheel. He wants the wheel built before the speed kicks in.
- **The number:** roughly 1% of total AI research and capital is going into safety. He called this dangerously inadequate against the pace of capability gains.
- **The stakes:** "We don't know whether we can co-exist with super-intelligent AI." First time he has framed this as an existential coordination problem in such direct terms.
- **The ask:** binding international agreements, modeled on chemical and nuclear weapons treaties. Voluntary frameworks are not enough.

+ THE BIG PICTURE

Hinton stepping out from "concerned" to "existential" while the same week ships \$100M defense AI rounds and 600,000 new agents going to work is the fork everyone has been waiting for. **Capability is racing. Safety is walking. The middle ground is closing.** Whichever side has the better organized capital wins the next 24 months of policy.

02 . INVESTMENT . AI GOES TO WAR

\$100M just bought an AI brain for warfare.

QUICK TAKE

Scout AI announced a \$100M Series A on April 29 to scale Fury, its foundation model for unmanned warfare. The largest defense-tech Series A in US history. Co-led by Align Ventures and Draper Associates, with Booz Allen Ventures, Decisive Point, and others joining. Fury already has \$11M in Department of War contracts and a fully autonomous end-to-end strike mission demoed in its first 18 months.

WHAT YOU NEED TO KNOW

- **The model:** Fury is a Vision-Language-Action model. Translates a commander's intent into coordinated autonomous action across air, land, sea, and space fleets.
- **The proof:** \$11M in DoD contracts in year one. Already running on Polaris MRZR ATVs for Army logistics. Live demo of a fully autonomous AI-executed strike mission.
- **The pitch:** "Some AI companies are stepping back from defense. We're stepping up." A direct shot at Anthropic, Google DeepMind, and others pulling out of military work.
- **The scale plan:** \$115M total raised. 34-person team. Hardware-agnostic, designed to be the AI brain for any uncrewed platform.

+ THE BIG PICTURE

\$100M is the largest defense-tech Series A in US history. Booz Allen Ventures backed Shield AI to a \$5B+ valuation. **The same playbook is now running on autonomy itself.** Anduril's Lattice and Shield AI's Hivemind have company. The new battlefield is not the drone, it is the orchestration layer above the drone. Every commercial AI lab pulling out of defense just made room for a defense-native foundation model to emerge.

03 . FEATURE . WORKSPACE

Gemini just took over Google Workspace.

QUICK TAKE

Google's Workspace Gemini push hit a new gear this week. Docs, Sheets, Slides, and Drive now generate full first drafts, complex spreadsheets, and editable decks from a single prompt, pulling context from your Gmail, Chat, and Drive automatically. As of April 29, Gemini can also generate downloadable PDFs, Word, Excel, and CSV files inside the chat. The blank page is officially done.

WHAT YOU NEED TO KNOW

- **"Help me create" in Docs:** describe what you need. Gemini pulls from Gmail, Chat, and Drive to generate a fully formatted first draft. Match writing style and document format on the same canvas.
- **Sheets gets a real partner:** "Fill with Gemini" auto-populates tables. Hit 70.48% on the SpreadsheetBench benchmark. Build dashboards from natural language with zero formula syntax.
- **Slides one-shot decks:** generate full editable decks that match your existing theme. Drive becomes a search engine that summarizes results inside an AI Overview before you even open the file.
- **Universal export, April 29:** Gemini chat can now generate PDF, DOCX, XLSX, CSV, TXT, RTF, and Markdown files directly. No more copy-paste-reformat cycle.

WHY IT MATTERS

For 95% of knowledge workers, Workspace is where the work happens. **Embedding Gemini at the file level kills the "open ChatGPT in another tab" workflow that powered the first AI wave.** Standalone AI writing tools, formatting tools, summary tools, and chart-makers all just got their value priced into a Workspace seat. Productivity AI is becoming infrastructure, not an app category.

04 . FEATURE . AI AUDIO

ElevenLabs just turned music into a remix party.

QUICK TAKE

ElevenLabs relaunched ElevenMusic on April 29 as a fan-first creation, remix, and streaming platform. Around 4,000 human artists are on the platform on day one, including Liza Minnelli and Art Garfunkel. Stream a song, change its genre, change its tempo, share the remix. Fully licensed via Merlin and Kobalt deals. The first AI music platform built to make artists the partner, not the lawsuit.

WHAT YOU NEED TO KNOW

- **The pivot:** the original April 1 ElevenMusic was a text-to-song generator. The April 29 version is closer to Spotify plus a remix tool. Stream from real artists, then prompt your way to your own version.
- **The licensing:** deals with Merlin (independent labels) and Kobalt (largest independent publisher). Outputs cleared for commercial use. Direct contrast to Suno and Udio's RIAA settlements.
- **The hook for fans:** turn a Liza Minnelli track into lo-fi. Or a King Willonius song into drill. Remix counts toward your daily limit. Free tier ships seven songs a day.
- **The strategy:** ElevenLabs is now voice + music + sound effects + Studio + 11.ai under one roof. The "open ChatGPT in another tab" problem, but for audio production.

i WHY IT MATTERS

Suno and Udio fought the music industry. ElevenLabs partnered with it. **Two years from now, "AI generated this song" stops being a legal question and becomes a credit line.** The platforms that reach licensing deals first will get the catalog. The catalog is what fans want to remix. The remix is the new playlist. The new playlist is the new distribution. ElevenLabs just built the first version of that loop.

05 . RESEARCH PAPER . AUTONOMOUS AGENTS

AI agents just learned to run themselves.

QUICK TAKE

The April 30 arXiv batch ships another wave of agentic and neuro-symbolic papers, all pointing in the same direction: agents that take outcomes as rewards and reason compositionally without constant human babysitting. The early reads point at frameworks designed to handle real-world ops where the rules change mid-task. Pair this with the Scout AI raise and the trajectory is hard to miss.

WHAT YOU NEED TO KNOW

- **The shift:** from prompt-by-prompt agents to outcome-based reward loops. The agent decides its own intermediate steps and gets graded on whether the goal was achieved, not on how it got there.
- **The neuro-symbolic angle:** compositional reasoning that combines neural pattern matching with symbolic logic. Better at unfamiliar tasks than pure language models.
- **The applications:** autonomous ops, research assistants that run experiments end-to-end, enterprise workflows that adapt without rebuild.
- **The risk side:** the same designs that make agents reliable also reduce the moments where a human can intervene. Hinton's warning lives downstream of papers like these.

* WHAT TO WATCH

First wave of agents needed prompts. Second wave needed tools. Third wave is shipping itself. **Watch for the first major agent framework to expose outcome-reward training as a public API in the next quarter.** That is when this stops being a paper trail and becomes a deployment pattern. Track the same teams that pioneered tool-use to see who jumps first.

[Browse arXiv cs.AI submissions →](#)

06 . OPEN SOURCE . PRODUCTIVITY HACK

A giant orange cat is **fixing** the internet.

QUICK TAKE

Japanese indie developer ZOKUZOKU shipped Cat Gatekeeper, a free Chrome extension that drops a giant orange cat across your browser when you have scrolled X, Instagram, TikTok, or YouTube past your daily limit. Default: 60 minutes use, 5 minute forced break. You cannot click past the cat. It went viral in under 48 hours. Silicon Valley spent billions on focus apps and wellness programs. One indie dev solved it with a fat cat.

WHAT YOU NEED TO KNOW

- **The mechanic:** set a usage limit and a break duration. Once you hit the limit, the cat takes over the screen until your break is done. No hide button. No skip option.
- **The supported apps:** X, Instagram, TikTok, YouTube. Bluesky, Facebook, Threads, and Reddit are in screenshots from the dev.
- **The privacy:** page access is used only to display the overlay. No data collected. No data transmitted. Free, no ads.
- **The launch:** first posted on X on April 26 by @konekone2026. Listed on the Chrome Web Store within days. Featured by Fast Company, TechCrunch, and Dexerto inside a week.

→ DO THIS TODAY

Install Cat Gatekeeper before lunch. **Set the limit to 30 minutes today, 20 tomorrow.** If even one hour of doomscroll a day comes back as deep work, that is roughly 250 hours a year you just bought yourself. The cat is non-negotiable. That is the whole point.

[Install Cat Gatekeeper from the Chrome Web Store →](#)

EDITORIAL . MY TWO CENTS

The accelerator and the brake.

Six stories today. They look unrelated. They are not.

Hinton said unregulated AI is a fast car with no steering wheel. Hours later, Scout AI raised \$100 million to put an AI brain inside the actual fastest cars on the battlefield. Google made AI invisible inside the apps you already work in. ElevenLabs made music a place where fans become producers, with the labels actually on board. The arXiv batch advanced agents that decide their own steps. And one Japanese developer fixed the smallest, most personal version of the same problem with a giant cat.

Every story today is a vote on the same question. Are we adding the steering wheel, or are we just stepping on the gas? Workspace says faster. Fury says faster. The arXiv papers say faster. ElevenLabs says faster, but with the seatbelts on. Hinton says wheel. The cat says wheel.

Acceleration without an off-ramp is what makes Hinton nervous. Not the speed. The fact that the throttle and the steering have very different funding curves. Capital is buying speed because speed is measurable. Almost no one is buying brakes because brakes are boring and do not show up in a Q4 deck.

The interesting part: even the cat extension is a brake. A goofy one, sure. But it is the same shape as Hinton's argument, just at the personal scale. ElevenLabs' licensing deals are a brake too, an industrial one. A friction layer that someone has to design on purpose. Nobody adds friction by accident.

IF YOU TAKE ONE THING FROM THIS

The teams that build brakes into their products on purpose, before regulation forces it, will own trust as a feature. Trust compounds slower than scale, but it lasts longer.

Until tomorrow,

Vaibhav

LAST WEEK'S DROPS

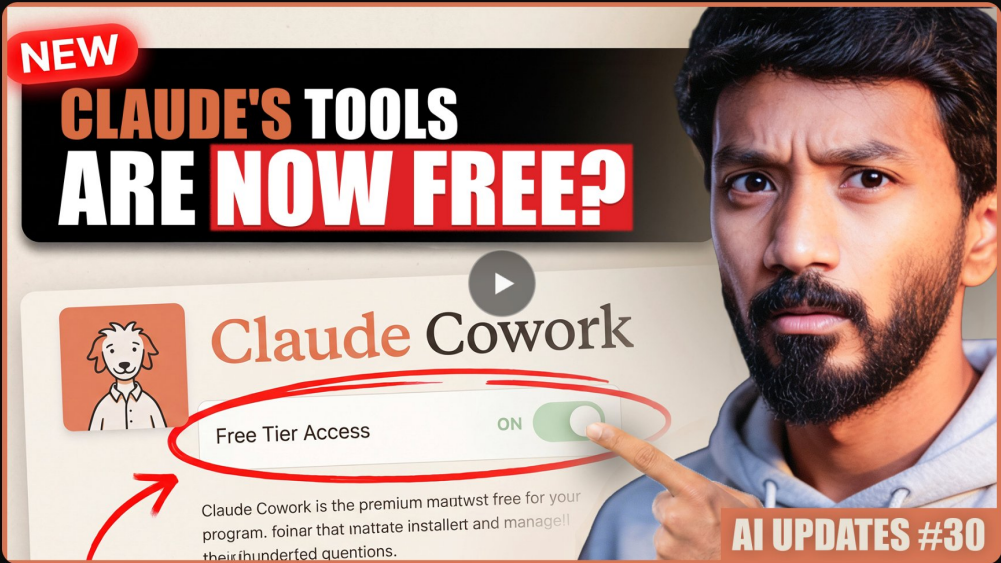
Catch up on the last 7 days.

Last week's AI Updates covered Claude Cowork, free AI tools, and 12 more drops. Tap to watch, or scan any thumbnail below.

Featured

This week's full recap

@vaibhavsinty
→



NEW
CLAUDE'S TOOLS ARE NOW FREE?

Claude Cowork

Free Tier Access **ON**

Claude Cowork is the premium mantwst free for your program. foinar that mattate installert and manageli theirihundredt questions.

AI UPDATES #30

// WATCH THE VIDEO

Anthropic Just Made *Claude Cowork* Work With Any AI For FREE (+12 AI Updates)

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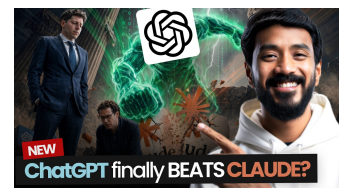
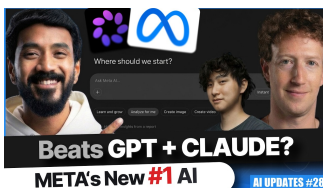


SCAN TO WATCH

Youtube

More from this week

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Zero fluff. The exact stack you need to stay one day ahead of everyone
else in AI.

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